

Site B, Student Interview 2

[0:00:00.0] **Interviewer:** Okey-dokey, so I have started recording. Okey-dokey. So like our first question for you is, thinking back to [Site B Instructor] class. I know now it's got a couple of weeks, but how did the lessons or discussions around data analysis go for you? What were your experiences like there? Does anything come to mind when you think about learning about qualitative data analysis?

Maria: Yeah. I think one of the things [0:00:30.0] I really liked about her class was that she gave us opportunities to practice in class. So when it came to like coding data, she'd give us data and say, Okay, Like get into groups and we'll code this and then we'll talk about your process. I think one of my favorite things that we did was we did participant observation, which is a little bit more like data collection. But it was really cool [0:01:00.0] because she's just like go around the room or go around the building and observe. And then we talked about like what that observation process was like. And it was helpful because then we had assignments. So we did our own participant observation and we did our own interview assignment and we had to code and do all those different things. And it was helpful to be able to do it in like a small chunk in [0:01:30.0] class where we can ask questions and then try it on our own in like a more robust way.

Interviewer: Okay, Awesome. So a couple of times you've used knowing which code and I'm wondering. Can you talk to me a little bit about how you think about coding qualitative. Qualitatively.

Maria: Yeah, So for me, coding is just like. Well, I was going to say just making little notes. But it's a it's [0:02:00.0] a little bit more structured than that. I would say like reading through and looking for themes and looking for. So there's different kinds of coding. There's open coding, there's, which is kind of when you do what I just said: you're kind of reading it and looking for things that are emerging. You might establish your codes in the beginning, which would be like these are the topics or things that we're [0:02:30.0] thinking about in advance. And so I kind of use those terms, I guess I use coding to, to encompass that whole process, acknowledging that it can be done in several different ways.

Interviewer: Awesome. Okey-dokey. So thinking back to your lessons and discussions around qualitative data analysis what approach to qualitative data analysis. Did you learn in this class like how would you name that approach?

Maria: I don't know I'm trying to think

Interviewer: [0:03:00.0] Yes, some of these questions are hard, so it's also okay if

Maria: I don't know, I feel like we learned, well, the way the class is structured, we learned about different kinds of studies. We like in qualitative, just overall. So we learned about like ethnography. And also apologies because I took two one inquiry class, like in the Inquiry department and then another class that covered similar topics in my like, personal department. So [0:03:30.0] some of it might mesh a little bit. But I'll try to isolate just what we did in [Site B Instructor] class. But we did, we learned about all of these different types of data analysis. And then we kind of practice the different data collection methods and things like that. And so when I think about analysis, I think a lot about the kind of study that we're doing. If you're doing, say like a grounded [0:04:00.0] theory study, that you might code your data differently than if you're doing, say, an ethnographic study. And so to me they're pretty, they're kind of

connected in, in that way. As far as the kind of data analysis, it's really to me, I think about it goes back to your research question. And what kind of research question you're asking and what form of analysis. Best to get the data, you need [0:04:30.0] to answer that question. So I don't know if I can name the different kinds of approaches, but that's sort of how I think about it.

Interviewer: Great. So, I'm kinda, I'm hearing you say that like connecting your data analysis, to like your bigger methodology or your bigger approach to how you're thinking like collecting qualitative data?

Maria: Yeah.

Interviewer: Okay. So what did you find helpful in the lessons and discussions [0:05:00.0] around analyzing your data, if anything at all. I know you already said that you thought it was helpful to do like, hands-on activities, where there anything else that you've found particularly helpful?

Maria: Yeah. I think instructor feedback was helpful. So not only just doing the hands-on activities, I think the discussion part was really helpful too. It's not just that we were doing the activities it was we were talking about them and you [0:05:30.0] were getting to hear the different ways that your classmates, were thinking about things. So especially the coding and the observation were two really interesting examples because different people pay attention to different things. And so it's interesting to see you know. We had a group of four and we were all observing the same thing and we all came away with like slightly different lenses. And that was interesting too, because it wasn't necessarily tied [0:06:00.0] to a research question. So that wasn't necessarily guiding how we were thinking about things. And then also then [Site B Instructor] adding like tips and feedback and things like that. And then I would also say the feedback and the written assignments as well. She had us often like pair our like our final paragraph of our. Whenever assignment we would do would be a reflection on the overall experience. And I remember writing about how I had [0:06:30.0] a I'm trying to remember exactly which one it was. I think I had like, I struggled to figure out what to focus on the observation or something or the interview. And she was like, Oh, well, if it's recorded, I would recommend you not take notes. And I was like, ooh, that's helpful for the next time I do this. So like little tidbits of insight and feedback that came through both in-class reflection [0:07:00.0] and written reflection as we turned in our assignment was also helpful.

Interviewer: Great. So I am going to share with you on the screen one of the activities that you all did just let's see here. Do you remember this [daughter] and her dad had an interview segment.

Maria: Oh yes this is about the lady who talked about retirement communities?

Interviewer: Yes

Maria: and then assisted living?

Interviewer: Yes. And then like at the end, [0:07:30.0] I think there was two sheets. So the first one was this sheet and then a second one was kind of like a coding exercise with columns and rows

Maria: I do remember this one.

Interviewer: Can you talk to me a little bit about how that entire exercise went for you?

Maria: Yes. Well, I remember I wrote so one thing about me. I really like different colored pens. [unintelligible] have a lot of them. I think [0:08:00.0] it's very fun and I specifically remember one of the things I enjoyed about this activity. First of all, it really helped me understand the difference between the different types of like memoing versus open coding versus I'm trying to remember what's the term for like coding that you decide ahead of time?

Interviewer: Like a priori or

Maria: yeah,

Interviewer: what is it, like. Induct, inductive, deductive. There's a million.

Maria: That was [0:08:30.0] the one I was thinking of that I just remember it was helpful because I chose like a different color pen for each different type of code. Like when I did the open coding, it was really easy to see, okay, this is what it is. And then when I added my own personal memos, I did it in a different color. And that was one where I do specifically remember classmates having kind of similar things, but [0:09:00.0] also different things that emerged in the coding as well. Where it was really helpful to be able to kind of think about it by ourselves, kind of like a think-pair-share. And then talk about it with people.

Interviewer: Was using the different colored pens, just something that you brought to the table or did [Site B Instructor] kind of suggest that you all think about maybe using different colors?

Maria: No. It was something that I just did. And [0:09:30.0] I remember another thing that I did that was, I mean, still within the assignment, but also a little bit different is I remember a lot of people were writing like separately because she gave us like the work sheet and then like a table to fill out.

Interviewer: Yeah.

Maria: And I remember like marking up the text where a lot of other people are writing like on the sheet. And I thought that was interesting too, [0:10:00.0] just like the different ways that people approach it and how it was adapted.

Interviewer: How did it like? How was your experience specifically marking it up on the on the sheet as opposed to going to a different piece of paper?

Maria: For me, I think it was just easier to like, look at it and get an idea of like what parts. Because I feel like it was on it. Because I, I think she had [0:10:30.0] us kind of summarize by paragraph. And then you have to look at both papers. You have to be like, Oh, what is paper? What is paragraph 1 versus what is paragraph 2. But also, I'm sure depending on people's handwriting and stuff, it might be nice to have a little bit more space for me. Easier to have it all on one page. So I wasn't like doing so much of that back and [0:11:00.0] forth.

Interviewer: Awesome. And you will also kind of jumping back a little bit. You talked about memoing and open coding. Can you talk to me a little bit about how you think about memoing like what is memoing to you.

Maria: Yeah. So to me, open coding was thinking about what specifically was in the text. So you know like she's taught in this specific exercise, she's talking about like her background,

working in assisted [0:11:30.0] care facilities and then how her experience impacted, you know, the way that she approached assisted living for her father. So. And I remember another theme was like everybody in the family was involved in medicine somehow. So like medicine in the family might have been like an open code because it's coming directly out of the text. And like, oh man, this must be really hard or really sad. That's like my own personal reflection [0:12:00.0] on the piece. And so like to me that would be a memo like, Oh, this makes me feel sad. To me. It was more like my own internal reactions or my own thoughts or opinions that weren't emerging directly from the text. That might be related to the text, but not coming directly out of it.

Interviewer: Great. Okey. Dokey. Well, let's see. Okay. And then [Site B Instructor] also instructed you all to watch a film [0:12:30.0] or do you remember that film? Kind of, I think on the last the last few classes?

Maria: We watched a couple is this the painting film or the film about the Jewish people?

Interviewer: I think it was the film about the Jewish people.

Maria: Okay.

Interviewer: Do you want to tell me a bit about how that was for you and like, I guess I'm interested in some of the questions that [Site B Instructor], like set [0:13:00.0] up or like what you were thinking about as you're watching that film?

Maria: That film was interesting. I remember this is like I'll get to your point. I'm just remembering how angry I was at the end because the researcher just died and they like ended the film. Just like not gonna finish? Like the research is over. She died.

Interviewer: Yeah.

Maria: But I also think watching her journey with cancer and like [0:13:30.0] watching her get sicker and sicker. Like I remember, people in the class were like, kind of like shock, not shocked, shocked as a little bit of a strong word. But they were definitely a little bit impacted by like watching someone just like get sicker and sicker and sicker and have it all be recorded. But also the kinds of questions she was asking and the way her own personal experience with her help. And I think [0:14:00.0] she was Jewish. Being Jewish and connecting back to some of these like Jewish traditions through this process of dying it created some interesting conversations and was also an interesting thing to observe. And I think thinking back to why [Site B Instructor], had us watch that film? I think it was like an example of like ethnography. And also like, I think it was tied to like participant observation and just how to engage with a community. And so [0:14:30.0] I think we remember reflecting on like the kinds of questions that she was asking, the way she was engaging with the different participants. I remember there was a lady in the wig shot like when she was thinking about buying a wig. And this lady wore a wig because she wanted to cover her hair. And she was asking like some questions and we were like, wow, her questioning style, It's like very invasive or we [0:15:00.0] were thinking about those kinds of relationships. And I remember reflecting on the way that her own personal experience was shaping the research. Yeah.

Interviewer: As you think about, you know, feeling that film and class, how do you, how do you think that's supported the ways in which you understand or have come to understand, like analyzing qualitative data?

Maria: Well, I think, I think one like seeing examples, of like finished work is really helpful. [0:15:30.0] Yeah. I think another thing that was interesting. Yeah. Yeah. So I think like the finished example to me is one of the things that was most helpful. Film is really interesting because it's not like a paper where it's like, okay, let me talk about my research methods and like they don't like break all that stuff down.

Interviewer: Yeah.

Maria: So you kinda of have to like reverse engineer a little bit and [0:16:00.0] like okay, these were the questions that she was asking during the film. So it's not as clear as say like a research paper or like a conference presentation where they're like explaining their whole thought process. But I think you also, she, in another element of the film when she had these like reflection points where she was talking, you'd see her do a scene and interact with people, but then she also like [0:16:30.0] sit there and talk about what the process was like. And I think that that was interesting because in a lot of ways that served as her analysis. So she was while it might not have been written out, she was kind of analyzing her experience verbally in front of the camera. And I think that that was helpful too because even though it's not written, we're kind of seeing her. It was very eloquent and [0:17:00.0] she I'm sure she put a lot of time in before she recorded it. But you're kind of seeing her actively think through what this experience meant and how it ties back to what she was hoping to achieve.

Interviewer: So we are at well, the last question and it's my favorite question just because I feel like grad students like we have so much to offer, right? So our last question here is, what [0:17:30.0] suggestions might you have for an instructor teaching qualitative data analysis like differently in the future. So like once you do your participant observation and you have your data and you're ready to analyze your data, what suggestions might you have for instructors?

Maria: Yeah, I think my biggest suggestion would be to anchor some of these activities in literature and research questions. Because I think that that's a really big part of the process. It [0:18:00.0] was it was like in the semester, I was really glad we didn't have to do these things.

Interviewer: Yeah.

Maria: Because it's more work, especially the literature part. But, you know, as we're doing the coding, as we're doing some of these other things. Research questions really frame what you're looking for. And even, even if you're doing kind of more of an emergent study where, you know, maybe like a [0:18:30.0] grounded theory where you're building something out based on what you're observing. It's still helpful to have those questions to guide. And so as we're thinking about the different activities, I think that having some of that would be helpful and also writing good research questions. Takes some time and some getting used to. So I think the more practice you get with that, the better

Interviewer: Mmhm, totally

Maria: for the analysis part [0:19:00.0] specifically. And I know this is another thing where at [inaudible] was very clear like she likes, like the tactile experience of like highlighters and printing things out. But I know a lot of people like the data analysis software and maybe like bringing in a library and to the class. Especially if she's not super familiar to say like, these are the different, right, where we can do this on our own. But it would be [0:19:30.0] interesting to kind of, I think people are nervous to approach librarians about these types of things. But they're very knowledgeable. And having someone come in and say, Okay, I'm an

expert in this. These are the various resources the library has available. Here's a, here's how to set up an account. Here's what [my institution] offers. Here. Here's why you might consider using this or not. Would be helpful. Because I think [0:20:00.0] some people want to use the software and they can figure it out. But if there's a need, if there if there's not a need for people like struggle through that process, then why struggle?

Interviewer: yeah, totally. Is there anything else that you want to share with me today about literally anything about qualitative data analysis?

Maria: Yeah, there was one more thing I wanted to share earlier you asked me about, I think like [0:20:30.0] activities that supported learning and I forgot to share one other thing that I thought was helpful. So we had to do presentations about qualitative data analysis where we found, or like just like qualitative research in general and we found different topics and everybody, and then you gave like a class presentation about it. And I thought that that was another really cool example talking about like seeing finished research projects. And everybody in the class did [0:21:00.0] different examples so some people analyzed like formal papers and formal studies. And some people did like arts-based research or narrative studies or, you know, like there was a documentary. There was a wide range of examples. And of course, with any class, like some presentations more, were more resonant with me than others. But it was really cool to see like, you know, you're not going to necessarily see 20 different examples of different kinds of [0:21:30.0] qualitative research. But if everybody gets a 10 minute presentation about it, you get to see a wide spread of what qualitative research can be. And I think a lot of people are more, or at least me, I'll speak for myself. I think quantitative research is more like a visible, visible like outside of academia. Like you do science fair when you're like ten and they're experiments. It's quantitative research. And ever, you [0:22:00.0] know, numbers and data and statistics and all those things you hear about it. And I think qualitative research, especially if you don't have a masters or, you haven't done it in the past. It's a little bit more ambiguous. So to see what it can look like in all of its different forums is really cool.

Interviewer: awesome. Those are really helpful suggestions. Thank you so much for your time. At this point, I [0:22:30.0] think that we are all through our interview here. Do you have any questions or concerns for me before I let you go on with your Thursday?

Maria: No, I don't think so. I hope that was helpful.

Interviewer: No, this was really, actually really amazing. So thank you so much you and really provided awesome insights. And thank you again for your time. I hope that you have a good rest of your summer and you' [0:23:00.0] re able to catch some rest after your summer class.

Maria: Thanks, you too.

Interviewer: Buh-bye.

Maria: Bye.